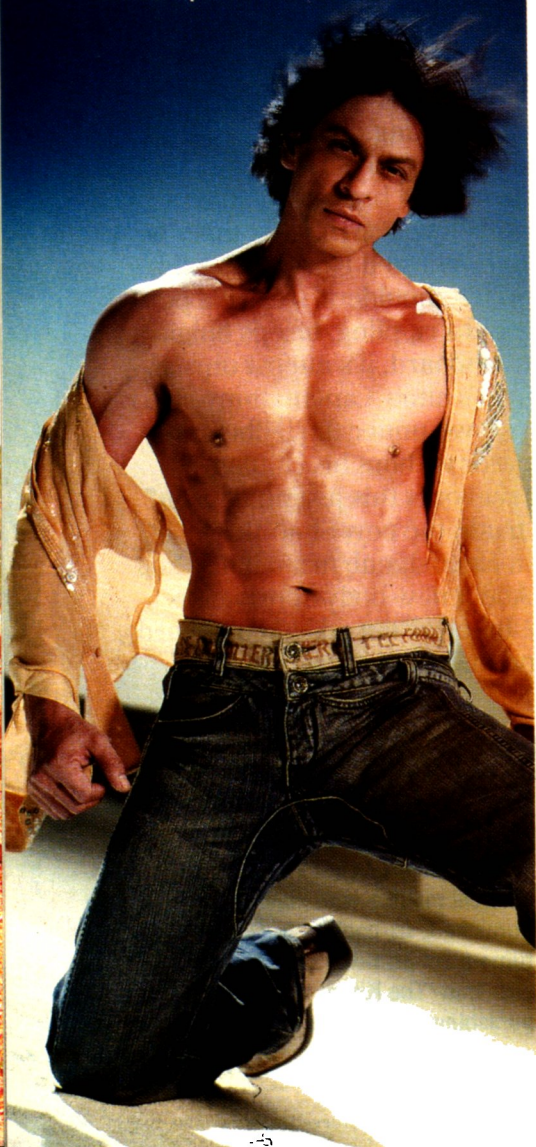


SHAH RUKH KHAN

For the longest time, he rubbished the image of a bodybuilder for a hero. Now it's hard to miss him in bare-chested glory—six-pack abs and a lean, mean, toned body. How did he do it? Cosmetic surgery? His trainer, Prashant Sawant, poooh-pooohs the allegation. It was sheer hard work—two hours of rigorous training four times a week, low-carb, high-protein diet and supplements—that did the trick, it seems. Meantime, Shah Rukh has followed Madonna and bought a 'magic' Power Plate machine for Rs 7.5 lakh, to tone up his muscles with high-speed vibration. Didn't his back problem get in the way? No, his back has healed. "Those who think it's impossible to achieve what he has at his age, I can only say that you have to meet him to believe the level of energy he has." The buffed-up look is here to stay.



The Ab Session

Check out some new procedures in cosmetic surgery:

ABDOMINAL ETCHING

Takes you a step beyond conventional fat removal through liposuction. This procedure is intended to give you a flatter, tighter stomach, with stronger muscle definition. Nothing is done on muscles, only excess fat and skin is removed.

BODY CONTOURING

After a major weight-loss, the skin becomes so stretched and loose that it hangs on legs, arms, stomach and chest. Body contouring is the surgical process that removes the extra skin.

FAT TRANSPLANT

It is a type of cosmetic surgery in which fat from one part of the body is used to fill wrinkle in another part, mostly your face. An injection is used to extract and inject fat from one part to the other. After extraction, the fat is processed to remove excess fluids. And then it is reinjected to the desired area.

ABDOMINOPLASTY

You get a washboard-flat stomach is achieved, by tightening or removing abdominal muscles. Does away with localised, exercise-resistant fat deposits, loosened and excessive muscles. Produces a more athletic appearance.

HIP THERAPY

It's bottoms up for Indian men. For every seven women, there are two men coming for butt treatment today. Hip reduction, inch loss, toning and firming are what they seek. Some get scars and hair removed too through laser treatment.

FACE PROCEDURES

These procedures are undertaken for changes that occur in facial bones. Volume is built up in areas of bone loss with fillers, lifting, repositioning and finally by reducing inelastic tissues.

there's an Adonis—all chiselled muscle and washboard abs. Urban Indian men are not just pumping iron or downing steroids to look better. Now, surgeons say, a rising number are asserting their manliness by taking recourse to new, and even controversial, procedures in cosmetic surgery. "Masculinity is no longer what you thought it was," says psychoanalyst Sudhir Kakar. Body perfect is now the credo and vanity the overriding motive.

And right now, the King of Bollywood is the role model. Shah Rukh Khan always makes headlines. But few could have predicted the squall of gossip, speculation, admiration, criticism and racing pulses that would follow after he stripped off his shirt for his forthcoming film, *Om Shanti Om*. While Khan and his trainer mention a tough regimen—cardio and weight training, special low-carb, high protein diet, amino acid supplements and fat burners—the

shadow of cosmetic surgery refuses to fade away. The media still can't get enough of the superhero abs ("What's the story behind Khan's six-pack abs?"). Bollywood-watchers are busy guessing the message his pictures might send ("After all, he spent two decades proclaiming he was an actor, not a bodybuilder"). And fans are in a frenzy: "If SRK undergoes plastic surgery, how would you react?" asks a fan blog. "What has taken people by surprise is the unexpectedness of it," says Jamal Shaikh, editor of *Men's Health*. "Stars with stomachs of steel have been around for years. But when the leading actor suddenly shifts from an athletic to a super-sculpted look at the age of 42, many an eyebrow is raised."

Doctors are not surprised. "There is a perceptible change in the male attitude towards reinventing their body image through cosmetic surgery. And it's a made-to-order